Ref. Ares(2024)829785 - 04/02/2024

With the support of the Erasmus+ Programme of the European Union

JEAN MONNET MODULE – EU Pathways to Engagement in the Western Balkans

Teaching Course Syllabus "The Western Balkans toward EU integration: Actors, strategies, and challenges"

Faculty of History and Philology

The teaching course will provide International Relations MA students with knowledgeof the EU strategy toward the region in the last 20 years and the factors and actors of the regional cooperation. The interdisciplinary teaching course is divided in two parts that will address EU membership process of the WB countries, regional cooperation and the political, legal, economic, and international aspects of the issues covered.

The Course will be implemented by the Faculty of History and Philology and will be open to Ma students in International Relations. The course is scheduled for the first semesterof the academic year and will involve around 40 students per year.

The first part will address the legal aspects, actors, and instruments of the accession process of WB candidates. This part (Dr. Meljana Bregu) will include topics as:

- The Thessaloniki agenda for the Western Balkans: Moving towards European integration.
- Legal dimensions of the EU accession policy.
- EU transformative power in the Western Balkans.
- The use of conditionality in the region on the implementation of structural reforms (Albanian case).
- Regional dynamics and external influences in the region
- The Berlin process and the Open Balkans Initiative
- New enlargement methodology, its challenges and impact on the integration process of the WB.

The second part (Dr. Juliana Gjinko) of the course will address economic issues and will include the following topics:

-Economic rationale for EU integration; An historical and economic overview

Economic regional policy and integration

-EU integration and comparative advantages of free trade

-Factor market integration: capital flows and migration

-Optimal currency areas; Balkan perspective on monetary issues

-The common agriculture policy

-Dynamics of economic transitioning in the Balkans

Suggested Literature:

- *The Origins & Development of the European Union 1945-2008 - A History of European Integration*, Edited Martin Dedman, London, Routledge, 2008
- *Balkan Regional Cooperation and European Integration* - Othon Anastasakis and Vesna Bojicic – Dzelilovic
- *Between Engagement and Cold Feet* - Rosa Balfour and Corina Stratulat
- *Culture of Regional Cooperation in Southeast Europe* - Balkans in Europe Policy Advisory Group
- *The EU and the Western Balkans after the Berlin Process* -Florent Marciaq
- *Off Track. The EU's Re-engagement with the Western Balkans* - Matteo Bonomi
- *Through the Labyrinth of the Regional Cooperation* - BiEPAG
- *The Regional Cooperation in the Western Balkans and the Open Balkans Initiative* - Meljana Bregu
- *How the Euro became our money, a short history of the euro banknotes and,* EuropeanCentral Bank